

Qualification Pack



Central Sterile Service Department (CSSD) Assistant

QP Code: HSS/Q6201

Version: 4.0

NSQF Level: 4.5

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HSS/Q6201: Central Sterile Service Department (CSSD) Assistant

Brief Job Description

The individual at this job are responsible for functions of decontamination, assembly and sterile processing, sterile storage and distribution. They direct personnel of department for sterilization, cleaning and disinfection process. They should be able to adapt with application of automation or robotics in sterilization systems, storage/retrieval system and other tasks. Individuals would keep oneself abreast with advancement in sterilization techniques, software solutions and electronic documentation.

Personal Attributes

The job requires individuals to have good communication and ability to handle a high level of stress and activity while managing fast-paced office duties. The job requires individuals to possess key qualities such as confidence, maturity, compassion, patient centricity, active listening, compassionate, strong interpersonal skills and the ability to work as part of a team, capable to handle work pressure with cool mind, be focused and attentive to detail, eager to learn and update knowledge.

Applicable National Occupational Standards (NOS)

Compulsory NOS:

1. [HSS/N5648: Comply to CSSD Process flow as per organizational policies and procedures](#)
2. [HSS/N5649: Manage availability, effectiveness and reprocessing of reusable medical devices](#)
3. [HSS/N5646: Receive, Inspect, Document, sterile and pack \(label\) CSSD items](#)
4. [HSS/N5650: Manage sterile stock of CSSD Items and work within sterile field boundaries](#)
5. [HSS/N5647: Perform Routine care of sterilizing apparatus and equipment](#)
6. [HSS/N9624: Maintain a safe and secure working environment](#)
7. [DGT/VSQ/N0102: Employability Skills \(60 Hours\)](#)

Qualification Pack (QP) Parameters

Sector	Healthcare
Sub-Sector	Allied Health & Paramedics
Occupation	Non-Direct Care

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Country	India
NSQF Level	4.5
Credits	40
Aligned to NCO/ISCO/ISIC Code	NCO-2015/2269.0700
Minimum Educational Qualification & Experience	12th grade Pass with NA of experience OR 10th grade pass with 3 Years of experience Experience in healthcare sector OR 11th grade pass with 1.5 years of experience experience in healthcare sector OR Previous relevant Qualification of NSQF Level (3.5) with 1.5 years of experience experience in healthcare sector OR Previous relevant Qualification of NSQF Level (3) with 3 Years of experience experience in healthcare sector
Minimum Level of Education for Training in School	12th Class
Pre-Requisite License or Training	NA
Minimum Job Entry Age	18 Years
Last Reviewed On	NA
Next Review Date	08/05/2028
NSQC Approval Date	08/05/2025
Version	4.0
Reference code on NQR	QG-4.5-HE-04220-2025-V2-HSSC
NQR Version	2

Remarks:

NA

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HSS/N5648: Comply to CSSD Process flow as per organizational policies and procedures

Description

This Occupational Standard describes the knowledge, understanding and skills required to ensure mechanical cleaning equipment (ultrasonic and mechanical washer-disinfectors) installed and monitored.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- the basic structure and function of healthcare delivery system
- the functions, importance and layout of CSSD department
- apply the concepts of microbiology
- apply infection control policies and procedures
- the process to assess and address the sterilization and cleaning needs of other departments

Elements and Performance Criteria

the basic structure and function of healthcare delivery system

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** know the healthcare delivery system in India at primary, secondary, tertiary, and quaternary level
- PC2.** understand the private, public, and non-profit healthcare delivery systems
- PC3.** know the variety of patient care services provided within a hospital setting
- PC4.** the various departments within a hospital and their roles

the functions, importance and layout of CSSD department

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC5.** understand the importance of CSSD in minimizing the chance of spreading infection by ensuring all procedures are conducted in a sterile environment.
- PC6.** the departments of a hospital or health facility in which CSSD delivers the sterile supplies of reusable surgical equipment, linen, dressing material.

apply the concepts of microbiology

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC7.** understand harmful microorganisms that cause infections
- PC8.** the importance of using appropriate sterilization techniques (e.g. autoclaving) for elimination of all microorganisms, including spores
- PC9.** the application of microbiological principles and proper handling techniques of medical instrument could prevent cross – contamination

apply infection control policies and procedures

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC10.** the importance of infection control and prevention.
- PC11.** know various vaccinations against common infectious diseases

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the process to assess and address the sterilization and cleaning needs of other departments

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC12.** understand the process of collecting soiled and contaminated medical devices from various hospital departments and transporting them to the CSSD's decontamination area
- PC13.** understand the precautions taken during this transport to prevent further contamination and ensure safety
- PC14.** understand the unidirectional flow and types of different zone in CSSD

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** the healthcare delivery system in India at primary, secondary, tertiary, and quaternary level
- KU2.** how to identify and follow procedures for safe practice
- KU3.** how to identify and comply with relevant organisational HSE policies and procedures
- KU4.** the hospital departments collaborate to provide integrated patient care
- KU5.** the importance of CSSD in minimizing the chance of spreading infection by ensuring all procedures are conducted in a sterile environment
- KU6.** departments of a hospital or health facility in which CSSD delivers the sterile supplies of reusable surgical equipment, linen, dressing material and other such items (e.g.: Operation Theatres, Labor Rooms, Minor OTs, HDUs, ICUs, Emergency Units, Wards (IPDs), Day Care Units and Outpatient Departments (OPDs).
- KU7.** process flow and unidirectional flow and zoning set for CSSD as per guidelines for different sections of CSSD: Receiving area, Sub Store, Cotton and Gauze preparation area, Cleaning Area, Assembly and Packing Area, Labelling and Packing Area, Sterilization Area, ETO Process Room, Storage Area, Issue and Distribution Area.
- KU8.** collection, segregation, washing of different category of equipment and packaging.
- KU9.** ensuring infection control principles and standard precautions are followed.
- KU10.** harmful microorganisms that cause infections.
- KU11.** the importance of using appropriate sterilization techniques (e.g. autoclaving) for elimination of all microorganisms, including spores
- KU12.** the application of microbiological principles and proper handling techniques of medical instrument could prevent cross contamination
- KU13.** various vaccinations against common infectious diseases
- KU14.** the various types of colour coded bins/containers used for disposal of biomedical waste.
- KU15.** the process of collecting soiled and contaminated medical devices from various hospital departments and transporting them to the CSSD's decontamination area
- KU16.** the initial processing of medical items upon arrival in the CSSD, including the sorting criteria and the pre-cleaning methods employed.
- KU17.** the sterilization process for packaged medical items in the CSSD
- KU18.** the different sterilization monitoring tool, physical monitors, biological indicators and chemical indicators

Generic Skills (GS)

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User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** ensure documentation is complete and accurate
- GS2.** read and interpret policies and procedures, standards operating procedures
- GS3.** demonstrate communication skills as required by specific work role
- GS4.** interpret and follow verbal and/or written instructions
- GS5.** report incidents in line with organisation requirements
- GS6.** discuss task lists, schedules, and work-loads with co-workers
- GS7.** send and receive message accurately
- GS8.** make decisions pertaining to the concerned area of work
- GS9.** organise own workload in accordance with supervisor requirements
- GS10.** apply knowledge of the importance of cleaning as a contribution to client safety
- GS11.** apply problem solving skills - to use available resources and prioritise workload
- GS12.** monitor printouts and take corrective action to address deviations outside verified cycle parameters
- GS13.** analyse workplace information to determine mechanical cleaning equipment requirements
- GS14.** source and apply information and methods and testing for chemical dosing
- GS15.** source and interpret information and standards relating to cleaning equipment
- GS16.** take into account opportunities to address waste minimisation, environmental responsibility and sustainable practice issues, including appropriate practices to ensure efficient use of resources
- GS17.** test effectiveness of the cleaning process and determine acceptability of test results

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>the basic structure and function of healthcare delivery system</i>	15	10	5	10
PC1. know the healthcare delivery system in India at primary, secondary, tertiary, and quaternary level	-	-	-	-
PC2. understand the private, public, and non-profit healthcare delivery systems	-	-	-	-
PC3. know the variety of patient care services provided within a hospital setting	-	-	-	-
PC4. the various departments within a hospital and their roles	-	-	-	-
<i>the functions, importance and layout of CSSD department</i>	12	10	5	5
PC5. understand the importance of CSSD in minimizing the chance of spreading infection by ensuring all procedures are conducted in a sterile environment.	-	-	-	-
PC6. the departments of a hospital or health facility in which CSSD delivers the sterile supplies of reusable surgical equipment, linen, dressing material.	-	-	-	-
<i>apply the concepts of microbiology</i>	15	10	5	5
PC7. understand harmful microorganisms that cause infections	-	-	-	-
PC8. the importance of using appropriate sterilization techniques (e.g. autoclaving) for elimination of all microorganisms, including spores	-	-	-	-
PC9. the application of microbiological principles and proper handling techniques of medical instrument could prevent cross – contamination	-	-	-	-
<i>apply infection control policies and procedures</i>	12	10	5	5

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC10. the importance of infection control and prevention.	-	-	-	-
PC11. know various vaccinations against common infectious diseases	-	-	-	-
<i>the process to assess and address the sterilization and cleaning needs of other departments</i>	20	20	10	5
PC12. understand the process of collecting soiled and contaminated medical devices from various hospital departments and transporting them to the CSSD's decontamination area	-	-	-	-
PC13. understand the precautions taken during this transport to prevent further contamination and ensure safety	-	-	-	-
PC14. understand the unidirectional flow and types of different zone in CSSD	-	-	-	-
NOS Total	74	60	30	30

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National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	HSS/N5648
NOS Name	Comply to CSSD Process flow as per organizational policies and procedures
Sector	Healthcare
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Non-Direct Care, Non-Direct Care
NSQF Level	4.5
Credits	8
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	08/05/2025
Next Review Date	08/05/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	08/05/2025

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HSS/N5649: Manage availability, effectiveness and reprocessing of reusable medical devices

Description

This Occupational Standard describes the skills and knowledge required to ensure that reusable medical equipment and devices are maintained at a high operational and readiness standard.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Maintain, monitor and record stock levels of reusable medical devices and packing material
- Manage maintenance of reusable medical devices
- Provide information about the care of reusable medical equipment
- Facilitate monitoring and maintenance requirements

Elements and Performance Criteria

Maintain, monitor and record stock levels of reusable medical devices and packing material

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** maintain a record of usage as per agreed stock levels
- PC2.**
 - identify stock requirements against usage trends, availability and organisation policies and guidelines
- PC3.**
 - monitor quality of stock and storage condition, including temperature, light, humidity, pest control and stock organisation
- PC4.** check the quality of new reusable medical devices and packaging material at time of delivery
- PC5.**
 - replenish stocks of reusable medical devices and packaging material in order to meet demand
- PC6.**
 - prepare maintenance schedules in compliance with operational requirements and manufacturers' guidelines
- PC7.**
 - maintain practices that monitor all aspects of reprocessing in compliance with operational requirements and manufacturers' guidelines
- PC8.** analyse data collected for monitoring and maintenance
- PC9.**
 - complete records of results of monitoring, according to organisational policies and procedures
- PC10.** complete records of all equipment maintenance and repair
- PC11.** archive records to address legislative requirements
- PC12.** maintain, evaluate and act upon non-compliance records and reports
- PC13.** manage recall processes

Manage maintenance of reusable medical devices

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC14.** conduct random inspections of all reusable medical devices
- PC15.**
 - organise and monitor repair of reusable medical devices when it is beyond the scope of the department or organisation

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PC16. maintain a maintenance and repair record for medical devices

PC17. • follow organisation policies and procedures when reusable medical devices are beyond
• maintenance and repair

Provide information about the care of reusable medical equipment

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC18. • develop material to assist sterilisation staff to care for reusable medical devices compliant
• with manufacturer's information

PC19. conduct training sessions with sterilisation staff in the care of reusable medical devices

PC20. maintain a register of sterilisation staff competency in the care of reusable medical devices

Facilitate monitoring and maintenance requirements

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC21. • complete planned and regular random checks of data and tracking systems that monitor the
• decontamination cycle and machinery performance

PC22. • take action where discrepancies are identified, including recall procedures, machinery
• maintenance or repair, and chemical review, in accordance with manufacturers' guidelines
• and organisation policies and procedures

PC23. • follow practices and procedures for tracing back through the decontamination cycle to clients
• and users

PC24. • report any issues outside sphere of responsibility and competence, without delay and
• according to organisation policies and procedures

PC25. follow the protocols for critical incidents and sentinel events investigation

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

KU1. how to identify and follow procedures for safe practice

KU2. how to identify and comply with relevant organizational HSE policies and procedures

KU3. organisational procedures relating to code of practice, stock redundancy and disposal requirements of the organisation, purchasing of equipment and devices and trials for consumables

KU4. detailed knowledge of infection control principles as they affect the sterilisation work environment

KU5. detailed knowledge of instruments and associated care and maintenance requirements

KU6. organisational code of practice

KU7. hazard identification and risk control

KU8. HSE policies, guidelines and symbols and their relevance to working in the sterilisation area

KU9. relevant regulatory guidelines for sterilising services

KU10. infection prevention guidelines, especially in relation to the care of reusable medical equipment

KU11. storage requirements for reusable medical equipment

KU12. the legal responsibilities of health care providers in relation to confidentiality, client rights, duty of care and implications of negligence

KU13. guidelines for purchase, reprocessing and reporting non-compliance

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- KU14.** training and assessment requirements relevant to the care of reusable medical equipment
- KU15.** reusable medical equipment such as surgical and medical instrumentation, anaesthetic/respiratory equipment, hollow ware, specialist surgical instruments and fibre optic equipment
- KU16.** items and materials required for packing such as internal chemical indicators, sterilisation tape, tray liners, tamper proof devices, rigidsterilisation container filters etc.

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** complete documentation accurately of tests, cycles and items and proof of process
- GS2.** maintain stock registers
- GS3.** maintain training registers
- GS4.** maintain a maintenance and repair record for medical devices
- GS5.** read and interpret policies and procedures, standards operating procedures, information sheets, instruction manuals
- GS6.** demonstrate communication skills as required by specific work role
- GS7.** demonstrate active listening skills
- GS8.** interpret and follow verbal and/or written instructions
- GS9.** report incidents in line with organizational requirements
- GS10.** discuss task lists, schedules, and work-loads with co-workers
- GS11.** send and receive message accurately
- GS12.** make decisions pertaining to the concerned area of work
- GS13.** select and use personal protection equipment
- GS14.** organise own workload in accordance with supervisor requirements
- GS15.** address relevant HSE, infection control and manual handling requirements
- GS16.** the importance of sterilization technology as a contribution to client safety and the relationship to well-maintained reusable medical equipment
- GS17.** follow organization policies and procedures for problem solving in relation to maintenance of reusable medical devices
- GS18.** determine stock requirements against usage trends, availability

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Maintain, monitor and record stock levels of reusable medical devices and packing material</i>	10	5	5	30
PC1. maintain a record of usage as per agreed stock levels	-	-	-	-
PC2. - identify stock requirements against usage trends, availability and organisation policies and - guidelines	-	-	-	-
PC3. - monitor quality of stock and storage condition, including temperature, light, humidity, pest - control and stock organisation	-	-	-	-
PC4. check the quality of new reusable medical devices and packaging material at time of delivery	-	-	-	-
PC5. - replenish stocks of reusable medical devices and packaging material in order to meet - demand	-	-	-	-
PC6. - prepare maintenance schedules in compliance with operational requirements and - manufacturers' guidelines	-	-	-	-
PC7. - maintain practices that monitor all aspects of reprocessing in compliance with operational - requirements and manufacturers' guidelines	-	-	-	-
PC8. analyse data collected for monitoring and maintenance	-	-	-	-
PC9. - complete records of results of monitoring, according to organisational policies and - procedures	-	-	-	-
PC10. complete records of all equipment maintenance and repair	-	-	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC11. archive records to address legislative requirements	-	-	-	-
PC12. maintain, evaluate and act upon non-compliance records and reports	-	-	-	-
PC13. manage recall processes	-	-	-	-
<i>Manage maintenance of reusable medical devices</i>	8	5	10	30
PC14. conduct random inspections of all reusable medical devices	-	-	-	-
PC15. - organise and monitor repair of reusable medical devices when it is beyond the scope of the - department or organisation	-	-	-	-
PC16. maintain a maintenance and repair record for medical devices	-	-	-	-
PC17. - follow organisation policies and procedures when reusable medical devices are beyond - maintenance and repair	-	-	-	-
<i>Provide information about the care of reusable medical equipment</i>	10	5	10	30
PC18. - develop material to assist sterilisation staff to care for reusable medical devices compliant - with manufacturer's information	-	-	-	-
PC19. conduct training sessions with sterilisation staff in the care of reusable medical devices	-	-	-	-
PC20. maintain a register of sterilisation staff competency in the care of reusable medical devices	-	-	-	-
<i>Facilitate monitoring and maintenance requirements</i>	10	5	10	15
PC21. - complete planned and regular random checks of data and tracking systems that monitor the - decontamination cycle and machinery performance	-	-	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC22. - take action where discrepancies are identified, including recall procedures, machinery - maintenance or repair, and chemical review, in accordance with manufacturers' guidelines - and organisation policies and procedures	-	-	-	-
PC23. - follow practices and procedures for tracing back through the decontamination cycle to clients - and users	-	-	-	-
PC24. - report any issues outside sphere of responsibility and competence, without delay and - according to organisation policies and procedures	-	-	-	-
PC25. follow the protocols for critical incidents and sentinel events investigation	-	-	-	-
NOS Total	38	20	35	105

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National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	HSS/N5649
NOS Name	Manage availability, effectiveness and reprocessing of reusable medical devices
Sector	Healthcare
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Non-Direct Care, Non-Direct Care
NSQF Level	4.5
Credits	4
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	08/05/2025
Next Review Date	08/05/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	08/05/2025

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HSS/N5646: Receive, Inspect, Document, sterile and pack (label) CSSD items

Description

This unit describes the process to assess and address the sterilization and cleaning needs of other departments, the systematic inspection process for cleaned medical items, the proper procedures for assembling clean and inspected instruments into functional sets or trays and the unidirectional flow and types of different zone.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- the concepts of cleaning and decontamination
- the different types of sterilization methods
- Identify and maintain a sterile environment in CSSD
- the principles of sterilization assurance
- Understand about Reporting and documentation.

Elements and Performance Criteria

the concepts of cleaning and decontamination

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** apply the concepts of cleaning and decontamination.
- PC2.** Identify the type of mechanical cleaning equipment required
- PC3.** Identify and maintain a sterile environment in CSSD
- PC4.** Understand the criteria for installation, operational and performance qualification of mechanical cleaning equipment in conjunction with manufacturer and organization policies
- PC5.** Understand the importance of MSDS
- PC6.** Understand the importance of knowing the chemical dosing levels
- PC7.** the importance of site inspection prior to installation for correct plumbing, ventilation and floor levels
- PC8.** Understand the cleaning methodologies and selection process of chemicals in accordance with instructions from manufacturer of mechanical cleaning equipment

the different types of sterilization methods

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC9.** understand the roles of pressure, saturated steam, temperature, and exposure time in achieving sterilization through protein denaturation
- PC10.** Identify and maintain a sterile environment in CSSD
- PC11.** Discuss the fundamental principle behind steam sterilization (autoclaving) in a CSSD
- PC12.** identify the different types of sterilization cycles used in autoclaving (gravity displacement, pre-vacuum, SFPP, and flash sterilization).

Identify and maintain a sterile environment in CSSD

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To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC13.** apply the concepts of cleaning and decontamination.
- PC14.** Identify the type of mechanical cleaning equipment required
- PC15.** Identify and maintain a sterile environment in CSSD

the principles of sterilization assurance

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC16.** understand the advantages of using steam sterilization compared to other sterilization methods in terms of effectiveness, reliability, speed, safety, and cost-effectiveness within a hospital setting.
- PC17.** understand the roles of pressure, saturated steam, temperature, and exposure time in achieving sterilization through protein denaturation.
- PC18.** identify the fundamental principles behind both Ethylene Oxide (ETO) and Hydrogen Peroxide Gas Plasma (HPGP) sterilization
- PC19.** assess in ETO and HPGP sterilization, highlighting the critical steps such as pre-conditioning, gas exposure, evacuation, aeration (for ETO), vacuum, hydrogen peroxide injection, and plasma generation (for HPGP).
- PC20.** know the standard operating procedures to identify a sterile field.
- PC21.** Understand the principles of sterilization assurance.
- PC22.** Identify and correctly use Physical Monitoring, chemical & biological indicators
- PC23.** Interpret results from quality indicators
- PC24.** appropriate action in case of sterilization failure
- PC25.** Maintain documentation and traceability of sterilization cycles

• *Understand about Reporting and documentation.*

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC26.** involve in tasks that require accurate record-keeping and adherence to established documentation procedures.
- PC27.** Understand about Reporting and documentation.
- PC28.** understand the importance of checklists and logs in the context of a CSSD Assistant's duties related to the assembly and packaging of instrument sets
- PC29.** know accurate record-keeping and adherence to established documentation procedures are considered vital for a CSSD Assistant's role in ensuring patient safety and the smooth operation of the hospital's Central Sterile Supply Department

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** how to identify and follow procedures for safe practice
- KU2.** organisational procedures relating to planning preventative maintenance for steam sterilisers
- KU3.** quality management documentation such as: monitoring, fault analysis, maintenance of sterilizers and steam quality non-conformance/non-compliance reporting validation reports fault registers maintenance record documentation relating to the non-conformance/noncompliance(fault detection, reporting and rectification)

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- KU4.** detailed knowledge of infection control principles as they affect the sterilisation work environment
- KU5.** detailed knowledge of the processes of maintaining and using tracking systems
- KU6.** detailed knowledge of the record keeping requirements and organisational policies and procedures
- KU7.** detailed knowledge of the working of all equipment and machinery used in the sterilisation cycle and support equipment e.g. boilers and steam reticulation
- KU8.** load release issues, including the variety of acceptable monitoring criteria suitable for load release
- KU9.** methods used to audit machine performance and report discrepancies
- KU10.** operation, monitoring and performance testing of downward displacement steam sterilizers and limitations on types of possible items for sterilization
- KU11.** relevant regulatory guidelines for sterilising services
- KU12.** routine monitoring, including trends in leak rate test results and appropriate action, air removal test results and appropriate action
- KU13.**
 - steam supply requirements including issues about boiler types and their location, steam
 - piping and steam delivery requirements and testing for steam quality - dry saturated steam,
 - superheat measurement and management
- KU14.** steriliser construction and operation such as steam quality, pre-vacuum steam steriliser, load retaining device, chamber cleaning accessories, water quality (feed and service), steam source, reticulation, trapping, solenoids, drain lines, air removal pumps, vacuum pump, operational parameters, etc. Hydrogen Peroxide plasma operational parameters etc
- KU15.**
 - monitoring and accessory equipment such as performance qualification equipment, superheat, thermocouple equipment, physical parametric process recorders, including printouts and graphics and chart recorders, external/internal chemical indicators, biological indicators and incubators, and enzymatic indicators, process challenge devices, performance
 - qualification equipment, including thermo-coupling devices, leak rate test, Bowie Dick type air removal test

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** ensure documentation is complete and accurate
- GS2.** read and interpret policies and procedures, standards operating procedures, HAZMAT information sheets, instruction manuals
- GS3.** demonstrate communication skills as required by specific work role
- GS4.** demonstrate active listening skills
- GS5.** interpret and follow verbal and/or written instructions
- GS6.** report incidents in line with organisation requirements
- GS7.** discuss task lists, schedules, and work-loads with co-workers
- GS8.** send and receive message accurately
- GS9.** make decisions pertaining to the concerned area of work
- GS10.** select and use personal protection equipment
- GS11.** prepare, operate, load and unload sterilisers

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- GS12.** organise own workload in accordance with supervisor requirements
- GS13.** address relevant HSE, infection control and manual handling requirements
- GS14.** use and monitor low temperature sterilizers (peracetic acid and hydrogen peroxide plasma), including loading and operation, physical, chemical and biological monitoring, maintenance by operators, liaison with service contractors
- GS15.** use methods to audit machine performance
- GS16.** take into account opportunities to address waste minimisation, environmental responsibility and sustainable practice issues, including appropriate practices to ensure efficient use of resources
- GS17.** apply knowledge of the importance of cleaning as a contribution to client safety
- GS18.** apply problem solving skills - to use available resources and prioritise workload and troubleshoot
- GS19.** monitor printouts and take corrective action to address deviations outside verified cycle parameters
- GS20.** monitor quality of metal instrument surface and take corrective action as required
- GS21.** analyse workplace information to determine mechanical cleaning equipment requirements
- GS22.** source and apply information, methods and testing for chemical dosing
- GS23.** source and interpret information and standards relating to cleaning equipment
- GS24.** source and interpret local regulations and water quality information
- GS25.** take into account opportunities to address waste minimisation, environmental responsibility and sustainable practice issues, including appropriate practices to ensure efficient use of resources
- GS26.** test effectiveness of the cleaning process and determine acceptability of test results

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>the concepts of cleaning and decontamination</i>	20	10	5	30
PC1. apply the concepts of cleaning and decontamination.	-	-	-	-
PC2. Identify the type of mechanical cleaning equipment required	-	-	-	-
PC3. Identify and maintain a sterile environment in CSSD	-	-	-	-
PC4. Understand the criteria for installation, operational and performance qualification of mechanical cleaning equipment in conjunction with manufacturer and organization policies	-	-	-	-
PC5. Understand the importance of MSDS	-	-	-	-
PC6. Understand the importance of knowing the chemical dosing levels	-	-	-	-
PC7. the importance of site inspection prior to installation for correct plumbing, ventilation and floor levels	-	-	-	-
PC8. Understand the cleaning methodologies and selection process of chemicals in accordance with instructions from manufacturer of mechanical cleaning equipment	-	-	-	-
<i>the different types of sterilization methods</i>	20	10	5	-
PC9. understand the roles of pressure, saturated steam, temperature, and exposure time in achieving sterilization through protein denaturation	-	-	-	-
PC10. Identify and maintain a sterile environment in CSSD	-	-	-	-
PC11. Discuss the fundamental principle behind steam sterilization (autoclaving) in a CSSD	-	-	-	-

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC12. identify the different types of sterilization cycles used in autoclaving (gravity displacement, pre-vacuum, SFPP, and flash sterilization).	-	-	-	-
<i>Identify and maintain a sterile environment in CSSD</i>	20	10	10	-
PC13. apply the concepts of cleaning and decontamination.	-	-	-	-
PC14. Identify the type of mechanical cleaning equipment required	-	-	-	-
PC15. Identify and maintain a sterile environment in CSSD	-	-	-	-
<i>the principles of sterilization assurance</i>	20	10	10	-
PC16. understand the advantages of using steam sterilization compared to other sterilization methods in terms of effectiveness, reliability, speed, safety, and cost-effectiveness within a hospital setting.	-	-	-	-
PC17. understand the roles of pressure, saturated steam, temperature, and exposure time in achieving sterilization through protein denaturation.	-	-	-	-
PC18. identify the fundamental principles behind both Ethylene Oxide (ETO) and Hydrogen Peroxide Gas Plasma (HPGP) sterilization	-	-	-	-
PC19. assess in ETO and HPGP sterilization, highlighting the critical steps such as pre-conditioning, gas exposure, evacuation, aeration (for ETO), vacuum, hydrogen peroxide injection, and plasma generation (for HPGP).	-	-	-	-
PC20. know the standard operating procedures to identify a sterile field.	-	-	-	-
PC21. Understand the principles of sterilization assurance.	-	-	-	-
PC22. Identify and correctly use Physical Monitoring, chemical & biological indicators	-	-	-	-
PC23. Interpret results from quality indicators	-	-	-	-

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC24. appropriate action in case of sterilization failure	-	-	-	-
PC25. Maintain documentation and traceability of sterilization cycles	-	-	-	-
• <i>Understand about Reporting and documentation.</i>	25	15	15	-
PC26. involve in tasks that require accurate record-keeping and adherence to established documentation procedures.	-	-	-	-
PC27. Understand about Reporting and documentation.	-	-	-	-
PC28. understand the importance of checklists and logs in the context of a CSSD Assistant's duties related to the assembly and packaging of instrument sets	-	-	-	-
PC29. know accurate record-keeping and adherence to established documentation procedures are considered vital for a CSSD Assistant's role in ensuring patient safety and the smooth operation of the hospital's Central Sterile Supply Department	-	-	-	-
NOS Total	105	55	45	30

Qualification Pack

National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	HSS/N5646
NOS Name	Receive, Inspect, Document, sterile and pack (label) CSSD items
Sector	Healthcare
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Non-Direct Care, Non-Direct Care
NSQF Level	4.5
Credits	11
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	08/05/2025
Next Review Date	08/05/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	08/05/2025

Qualification Pack

HSS/N5650: Manage sterile stock of CSSD Items and work within sterile field boundaries

Description

This Occupational Standard describes the skills and knowledge required to apply procedures for handling, storage, maintenance of sterile stock and work within sterile field boundaries. The range of functions is prescribed around known standards, guidelines, policies and procedures

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- maintain sterility storage and Distribution
- inventory control and supply chain management systems
- process of workflow and traffic control in the decontamination area
- the strategic utilization of Information Technology (IT) within the CSSD
- the efficiency, accuracy, and patient safety in sterile processing

Elements and Performance Criteria

maintain sterility storage and Distribution.

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** to maintain sterility storage and transport.
- PC2.** know the process of transferring sterilized items after the sterilization cycle
- PC3.** the essential characteristics of a sterile storage area
- PC4.** identify compromised sterile packaging.
- PC5.** understand the importance of keeping sterile storage areas clean and dry
- PC6.** placements of racks for sterile good
- PC7.** know the process of distributing sterile supplies from the CSSD to various hospital departments
- PC8.** common methods used for distributing sterile supplies within the hospital
- PC9.** the importance of maintaining the integrity of sterile packaging during distribution
- PC10.** the rationale behind distributing sterile supplies on an as-needed basis and often following the first-in, first-out (FIFO) principle.

the inventory control and supply chain management systems

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC11.** Assembly and Packaging of equipment's including, assembling surgical instrument trays, sets, and packs according to established protocols and procedures
- PC12.** restocking sterile supplies and ensuring items are available for use
- PC13.** Inventory Control and keeping track of inventory levels and reporting shortages or issues to supervisors.
- PC14.** understand the basic flow of supplies into and out of the CSSD
- PC15.** the role of different departments and vendors in the supply chain

Qualification Pack

process of workflow and traffic control in the decontamination area

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC16. know the importance of a unidirectional workflow in the decontamination area

PC17. helps prevent cross-contamination

the efficiency, accuracy, and patient safety in sterile processing

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC18. understand the advantages of electronic documentation includes ,
accessibility,accuracy,efficiency

PC19. know the benefits of instrument tracking systems includes ,traceability, inventory
management , workflow management ,quality assurance

the strategic utilization of Information Technology (IT) within the CSSD

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC20. understand the IT systems can be used to manage the overall workflow within the CSSD

PC21. improve efficiency and reduce delays.

PC22. interact with workflow management software.

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

KU1. how to identify and follow procedures for safe practice

KU2. organisational procedures relating to infection control

KU3. organisational procedures to control stock

KU4. how to maintain stock levels within specified guidelines

KU5. how to monitor the necessary environmental conditions to maintain stock in a sterile
condition

KU6. correct storage and stock management principles for sterile stock

KU7. factors that affect shelf-life of sterile stock

KU8. features of a transport system required to maintain sterility of packaged items

KU9. fundamental knowledge of infection control principles as it affects the sterilisation work
environment sterilisation work environment

KU10. organisational policies and procedures regarding management of sterile stock

KU11. procedures to restrict access to sterile stock

KU12. how to identify imprecise items such as sterile stock, consumables and sterile equipment

KU13. how to identify compromised stock

KU14. factors that compromise sterile stock

KU15. recall processes which may relate to procedures to be followed

KU16. the legal responsibilities providers of health care in relation to the confidentiality, client
rights, duty of care and implications of negligence

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

Qualification Pack

- GS1.** ensure documentation is complete and accurate
- GS2.** read and interpret manufacturers' instructions for equipment, workplace safety pamphlets or procedure manuals
- GS3.** demonstrate communication skills as required by specific work role
- GS4.** demonstrate active listening skills
- GS5.** interpret and follow verbal and/or written instructions
- GS6.** report incidents in line with organization requirements
- GS7.** discuss task lists, schedules, and work-loads with co-workers
- GS8.** make decisions pertaining to the concerned area of work
- GS9.** select and use personal protection equipment
- GS10.** organise own workload in accordance with supervisors requirements
- GS11.** take into account, opportunities to address environmental responsibility and sustainable practice issues
- GS12.** follow the route and timetable for routine imprest delivery to designated destinations
- GS13.** apply knowledge of the importance of sterile stock as a contribution to client safety
- GS14.** solve problems including the ability to use available resources

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>maintain sterility storage and Distribution.</i>	13	10	5	35
PC1. to maintain sterility storage and transport.	-	-	-	-
PC2. know the process of transferring sterilized items after the sterilization cycle	-	-	-	-
PC3. the essential characteristics of a sterile storage area	-	-	-	-
PC4. identify compromised sterile packaging.	-	-	-	-
PC5. understand the importance of keeping sterile storage areas clean and dry	-	-	-	-
PC6. placements of racks for sterile good	-	-	-	-
PC7. know the process of distributing sterile supplies from the CSSD to various hospital departments	-	-	-	-
PC8. common methods used for distributing sterile supplies within the hospital	-	-	-	-
PC9. the importance of maintaining the integrity of sterile packaging during distribution	-	-	-	-
PC10. the rationale behind distributing sterile supplies on an as-needed basis and often following the first-in, first-out (FIFO) principle.	-	-	-	-
<i>the inventory control and supply chain management systems</i>	18	10	5	-
PC11. Assembly and Packaging of equipment's including, assembling surgical instrument trays, sets, and packs according to established protocols and procedures	-	-	-	-
PC12. restocking sterile supplies and ensuring items are available for use	-	-	-	-
PC13. Inventory Control and keeping track of inventory levels and reporting shortages or issues to supervisors.	-	-	-	-

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC14. understand the basic flow of supplies into and out of the CSSD	-	-	-	-
PC15. the role of different departments and vendors in the supply chain	-	-	-	-
<i>process of workflow and traffic control in the decontamination area</i>	18	5	5	-
PC16. know the importance of a unidirectional workflow in the decontamination area	-	-	-	-
PC17. helps prevent cross-contamination	-	-	-	-
<i>the efficiency, accuracy, and patient safety in sterile processing</i>	20	10	5	20
PC18. understand the advantages of electronic documentation includes , accessibility,accuracy,efficiency	-	-	-	-
PC19. know the benefits of instrument tracking systems includes ,traceability, inventory management , workflow management ,quality assurance	-	-	-	-
<i>the strategic utilization of Information Technology (IT) within the CSSD</i>	25	15	10	30
PC20. understand the IT systems can be used to manage the overall workflow within the CSSD	-	-	-	-
PC21. improve efficiency and reduce delays.	-	-	-	-
PC22. interact with workflow management software.	-	-	-	-
NOS Total	94	50	30	85

Qualification Pack

National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	HSS/N5650
NOS Name	Manage sterile stock of CSSD Items and work within sterile field boundaries
Sector	Healthcare
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Non-Direct Care, Non-Direct Care
NSQF Level	4.5
Credits	10
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	08/05/2025
Next Review Date	08/05/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	08/05/2025

Qualification Pack

HSS/N5647: Perform Routine care of sterilizing apparatus and equipment

Description

This unit describes the skills and knowledge required to Understand the efficiency, longevity, and safety of operations, also able to involves direct interaction with various pieces of equipment.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- manage efficiency, longevity, and safety of operations.

Elements and Performance Criteria

manage efficiency, longevity, and safety of operations.

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** the proper procedures for loading and unloading washer-disinfectors and ultrasonic cleaners
- PC2.** know the importance of daily and periodic cleaning of these machines
- PC3.** understand the safe handling of cleaning chemicals and enzymatic solutions used in these machines
- PC4.** know the role in recognizing and reporting any malfunctions or unusual noises during equipment operation
- PC5.** correct use and maintenance of manual sinks and associated accessories (brushes, spray guns).
- PC6.** understand the correct procedures for loading and unloading sterilizers (steam, ETO, HPGP)
- PC7.** know the importance of verifying the integrity of packaging before loading and after unloading.
- PC8.** performing routine checks, such as inspecting door gaskets and ensuring proper chamber drainage (for autoclaves).
- PC9.** the loading of chemical and biological indicators in sterilization cycles
- PC10.** the proper operation of heat sealers for pouches and reels and its validation through ink test . This includes ensuring correct temperature settings and creating strong, consistent seals.
- PC11.** importance of regularly cleaning and maintaining heat sealers to prevent malfunctions.
- PC12.** the proper loading and handling of sterile storage shelves and carts
- PC13.** the importance of keeping storage areas clean and dry and maintaining temperature and humidity as per guidelines
- PC14.** understand the care and maintenance of magnifying glasses used for detailed inspection.

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** procedures for loading and unloading washer-disinfectors and ultrasonic cleaners.
- KU2.** daily and periodic cleaning of these machines

Qualification Pack

- KU3.** the safe handling of cleaning chemicals and enzymatic solutions used in these machines.
- KU4.** the role in recognizing and reporting any malfunctions or unusual noises during equipment operation.
- KU5.** the correct use and maintenance of manual sinks and associated accessories (brushes, spray guns).
- KU6.** the correct procedures for loading and unloading sterilizers (steam, ETO, HPGP).
- KU7.** the importance of verifying the integrity of packaging before loading and after unloading
- KU8.** performing routine checks, such as inspecting door gaskets and ensuring proper chamber drainage (for autoclaves).
- KU9.** the loading of chemical and biological indicators in sterilization cycles
- KU10.** the procedures for responding to alarms or error messages on sterilizers and reporting them to the appropriate personnel
- KU11.** the proper operation of heat sealers for pouches and reels and its validation through ink test . This includes ensuring correct temperature settings and creating strong, consistent seals.
- KU12.** the correct techniques for wrapping instrument trays using various wrapping methods (e.g., sequential, simultaneous). Ensure proper folding and secure taping
- KU13.** the importance of using the correct size and type of packaging material for the items being sterilized
- KU14.** the proper loading and handling of sterile storage shelves and carts
- KU15.** the care and maintenance of magnifying glasses used for detailed inspection.
- KU16.** the general principles for handling and care of equipment

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** interpret and follow verbal and/or written instructions
- GS2.** select and use personal protection equipment
- GS3.** use and monitor low temperature sterilizers (peracetic acid and hydrogen peroxide plasma), including loading and operation, physical, chemical and biological monitoring, maintenance by operators, liaison with service contractors
- GS4.** take into account opportunities to address waste minimisation, environmental responsibility and sustainable practice issues, including appropriate practices to ensure efficient use of resources
- GS5.** monitor printouts and take corrective action to address deviations outside verified cycle parameters
- GS6.** source and apply information, methods and testing for chemical dosing
- GS7.** take into account opportunities to address waste minimisation, environmental responsibility and sustainable practice issues, including appropriate practices to ensure efficient use of resources
- GS8.** test effectiveness of the cleaning process and determine acceptability of test results
- GS9.** source and interpret information and standards relating to cleaning equipment
- GS10.** organise own workload in accordance with supervisor requirements

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>manage efficiency, longevity, and safety of operations.</i>	9	5	10	10
PC1. the proper procedures for loading and unloading washer-disinfectors and ultrasonic cleaners	-	-	-	-
PC2. know the importance of daily and periodic cleaning of these machines	-	-	-	-
PC3. understand the safe handling of cleaning chemicals and enzymatic solutions used in these machines	-	-	-	-
PC4. know the role in recognizing and reporting any malfunctions or unusual noises during equipment operation	-	-	-	-
PC5. correct use and maintenance of manual sinks and associated accessories (brushes, spray guns).	-	-	-	-
PC6. understand the correct procedures for loading and unloading sterilizers (steam, ETO, HPGP)	-	-	-	-
PC7. know the importance of verifying the integrity of packaging before loading and after unloading.	-	-	-	-
PC8. performing routine checks, such as inspecting door gaskets and ensuring proper chamber drainage (for autoclaves).	-	-	-	-
PC9. the loading of chemical and biological indicators in sterilization cycles	-	-	-	-
PC10. the proper operation of heat sealers for pouches and reels and its validation through ink test . This includes ensuring correct temperature settings and creating strong, consistent seals.	-	-	-	-
PC11. importance of regularly cleaning and maintaining heat sealers to prevent malfunctions.	-	-	-	-
PC12. the proper loading and handling of sterile storage shelves and carts	-	-	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC13. the importance of keeping storage areas clean and dry and maintaining temperature and humidity as per guidelines	-	-	-	-
PC14. understand the care and maintenance of magnifying glasses used for detailed inspection.	-	-	-	-
NOS Total	9	5	10	10

Qualification Pack

National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	HSS/N5647
NOS Name	Perform Routine care of sterilizing apparatus and equipment
Sector	Healthcare
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Non-Direct Care
NSQF Level	4.5
Credits	4
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	08/05/2025
Next Review Date	08/05/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	08/05/2025

Qualification Pack

HSS/N9624: Maintain a safe and secure working environment

Description

This OS unit is about the ensuring a safe and secure working environment

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Workplace safety and security

Elements and Performance Criteria

Workplace safety and security

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** identify potential hazards of safe work practices
- PC2.** use various hospital codes for emergency situations
- PC3.** comply with safety, and security procedures within the defined scope of competence and authority
- PC4.** provide Basic Life Support (BLS) and first aid whenever applicable under defined scope of work
- PC5.** follow organizations' procedures related to any emergency efficiently
- PC6.** report any identified breaches in health, safety, and security procedures to the designated person
- PC7.** complete any health and safety records accurately

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** the importance of health, safety, and security in the workplace
- KU2.** how to identify safety and security hazards
- KU3.** the importance of identifying individual responsibilities in relation to maintaining workplace safety and security requirements
- KU4.** the relevant up-to-date information on safety, and security that applies to the workplace
- KU5.** how to report any emergency
- KU6.** various hospital codes for emergency situations
- KU7.** how to create safety records and maintain them
- KU8.** concept of first aid and BLS
- KU9.** the importance of raising alarm about hazards for safety of others

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

Qualification Pack

- GS1.** read and understand organization policies and procedures
- GS2.** prepare status and progress reports
- GS3.** • communicate information (for example, facts, ideas, or messages) in a brief, clear, and
• organized manner
- GS4.** make decisions pertaining to the area of work
- GS5.** plan for safety of the work environment
- GS6.** identify hazards, evaluate possible solutions and suggest effective solutions
- GS7.** analyze the seriousness of hazards

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Workplace safety and security</i>	10	10	-	10
PC1. identify potential hazards of safe work practices	-	-	-	-
PC2. use various hospital codes for emergency situations	-	-	-	-
PC3. comply with safety, and security procedures within the defined scope of competence and authority	-	-	-	-
PC4. provide Basic Life Support (BLS) and first aid whenever applicable under defined scope of work	-	-	-	-
PC5. follow organizations' procedures related to any emergency efficiently	-	-	-	-
PC6. report any identified breaches in health, safety, and security procedures to the designated person	-	-	-	-
PC7. complete any health and safety records accurately	-	-	-	-
NOS Total	10	10	-	10

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National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	HSS/N9624
NOS Name	Maintain a safe and secure working environment
Sector	Healthcare
Sub-Sector	Generic
Occupation	Generic
NSQF Level	4
Credits	1
Version	2.0
Last Reviewed Date	12/03/2026
Next Review Date	12/03/2029
NSQC Clearance Date	12/03/2026

Qualification Pack

DGT/VSQ/N0102: Employability Skills (60 Hours)

Description

This unit is about employability skills, Constitutional values, becoming a professional in the 21st Century, digital, financial, and legal literacy, diversity and Inclusion, English and communication skills, customer service, entrepreneurship, and apprenticeship, getting ready for jobs and career development.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Introduction to Employability Skills
- Constitutional values - Citizenship
- Becoming a Professional in the 21st Century
- Basic English Skills
- Career Development & Goal Setting
- Communication Skills
- Diversity & Inclusion
- Financial and Legal Literacy
- Essential Digital Skills
- Entrepreneurship
- Customer Service
- Getting ready for Apprenticeship & Jobs

Elements and Performance Criteria

Introduction to Employability Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** identify employability skills required for jobs in various industries
- PC2.** identify and explore learning and employability portals

Constitutional values – Citizenship

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC3.** recognize the significance of constitutional values, including civic rights and duties, citizenship, responsibility towards society etc. and personal values and ethics such as honesty, integrity, caring and respecting others, etc.
- PC4.** follow environmentally sustainable practices

Becoming a Professional in the 21st Century

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC5.** recognize the significance of 21st Century Skills for employment
- PC6.** practice the 21st Century Skills such as Self-Awareness, Behaviour Skills, time management, critical and adaptive thinking, problem-solving, creative thinking, social and cultural awareness, emotional awareness, learning to learn for continuous learning etc. in personal and professional life

Basic English Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

Qualification Pack

- PC7.** use basic English for everyday conversation in different contexts, in person and over the telephone
- PC8.** read and understand routine information, notes, instructions, mails, letters etc. written in English
- PC9.** write short messages, notes, letters, e-mails etc. in English

Career Development & Goal Setting

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC10.** understand the difference between job and career
- PC11.** prepare a career development plan with short- and long-term goals, based on aptitude

Communication Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC12.** follow verbal and non-verbal communication etiquette and active listening techniques in various settings
- PC13.** work collaboratively with others in a team

Diversity & Inclusion

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC14.** communicate and behave appropriately with all genders and PwD
- PC15.** escalate any issues related to sexual harassment at workplace according to POSH Act

Financial and Legal Literacy

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC16.** select financial institutions, products and services as per requirement
- PC17.** carry out offline and online financial transactions, safely and securely
- PC18.** identify common components of salary and compute income, expenses, taxes, investments etc
- PC19.** identify relevant rights and laws and use legal aids to fight against legal exploitation

Essential Digital Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC20.** operate digital devices and carry out basic internet operations securely and safely
- PC21.** use e- mail and social media platforms and virtual collaboration tools to work effectively
- PC22.** use basic features of word processor, spreadsheets, and presentations

Entrepreneurship

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC23.** identify different types of Entrepreneurship and Enterprises and assess opportunities for potential business through research
- PC24.** develop a business plan and a work model, considering the 4Ps of Marketing Product, Price, Place and Promotion
- PC25.** identify sources of funding, anticipate, and mitigate any financial/ legal hurdles for the potential business opportunity

Customer Service

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC26.** identify different types of customers
- PC27.** identify and respond to customer requests and needs in a professional manner.

Qualification Pack

PC28. follow appropriate hygiene and grooming standards

Getting ready for apprenticeship & Jobs

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC29. create a professional Curriculum vitae (Résumé)

PC30. search for suitable jobs using reliable offline and online sources such as Employment exchange, recruitment agencies, newspapers etc. and job portals, respectively

PC31. apply to identified job openings using offline /online methods as per requirement

PC32. answer questions politely, with clarity and confidence, during recruitment and selection

PC33. identify apprenticeship opportunities and register for it as per guidelines and requirements

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

KU1. need for employability skills and different learning and employability related portals

KU2. various constitutional and personal values

KU3. different environmentally sustainable practices and their importance

KU4. Twenty first (21st) century skills and their importance

KU5. how to use English language for effective verbal (face to face and telephonic) and written communication in formal and informal set up

KU6. importance of career development and setting long- and short-term goals

KU7. about effective communication

KU8. POSH Act

KU9. Gender sensitivity and inclusivity

KU10. different types of financial institutes, products, and services

KU11. how to compute income and expenditure

KU12. importance of maintaining safety and security in offline and online financial transactions

KU13. different legal rights and laws

KU14. different types of digital devices and the procedure to operate them safely and securely

KU15. how to create and operate an e- mail account and use applications such as word processors, spreadsheets etc.

KU16. how to identify business opportunities

KU17. types and needs of customers

KU18. how to apply for a job and prepare for an interview

KU19. apprenticeship scheme and the process of registering on apprenticeship portal

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

GS1. read and write different types of documents/instructions/correspondence

GS2. communicate effectively using appropriate language in formal and informal settings

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- GS3.** behave politely and appropriately with all
- GS4.** how to work in a virtual mode
- GS5.** perform calculations efficiently
- GS6.** solve problems effectively
- GS7.** pay attention to details
- GS8.** manage time efficiently
- GS9.** maintain hygiene and sanitization to avoid infection

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Introduction to Employability Skills</i>	1	1	-	-
PC1. identify employability skills required for jobs in various industries	-	-	-	-
PC2. identify and explore learning and employability portals	-	-	-	-
<i>Constitutional values – Citizenship</i>	1	1	-	-
PC3. recognize the significance of constitutional values, including civic rights and duties, citizenship, responsibility towards society etc. and personal values and ethics such as honesty, integrity, caring and respecting others, etc.	-	-	-	-
PC4. follow environmentally sustainable practices	-	-	-	-
<i>Becoming a Professional in the 21st Century</i>	2	4	-	-
PC5. recognize the significance of 21st Century Skills for employment	-	-	-	-
PC6. practice the 21st Century Skills such as Self-Awareness, Behaviour Skills, time management, critical and adaptive thinking, problem-solving, creative thinking, social and cultural awareness, emotional awareness, learning to learn for continuous learning etc. in personal and professional life	-	-	-	-
<i>Basic English Skills</i>	2	3	-	-
PC7. use basic English for everyday conversation in different contexts, in person and over the telephone	-	-	-	-
PC8. read and understand routine information, notes, instructions, mails, letters etc. written in English	-	-	-	-
PC9. write short messages, notes, letters, e-mails etc. in English	-	-	-	-
<i>Career Development & Goal Setting</i>	1	2	-	-

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC10. understand the difference between job and career	-	-	-	-
PC11. prepare a career development plan with short- and long-term goals, based on aptitude	-	-	-	-
<i>Communication Skills</i>	2	2	-	-
PC12. follow verbal and non-verbal communication etiquette and active listening techniques in various settings	-	-	-	-
PC13. work collaboratively with others in a team	-	-	-	-
<i>Diversity & Inclusion</i>	1	2	-	-
PC14. communicate and behave appropriately with all genders and PwD	-	-	-	-
PC15. escalate any issues related to sexual harassment at workplace according to POSH Act	-	-	-	-
<i>Financial and Legal Literacy</i>	2	3	-	-
PC16. select financial institutions, products and services as per requirement	-	-	-	-
PC17. carry out offline and online financial transactions, safely and securely	-	-	-	-
PC18. identify common components of salary and compute income, expenses, taxes, investments etc	-	-	-	-
PC19. identify relevant rights and laws and use legal aids to fight against legal exploitation	-	-	-	-
<i>Essential Digital Skills</i>	3	4	-	-
PC20. operate digital devices and carry out basic internet operations securely and safely	-	-	-	-
PC21. use e- mail and social media platforms and virtual collaboration tools to work effectively	-	-	-	-
PC22. use basic features of word processor, spreadsheets, and presentations	-	-	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Entrepreneurship</i>	2	3	-	-
PC23. identify different types of Entrepreneurship and Enterprises and assess opportunities for potential business through research	-	-	-	-
PC24. develop a business plan and a work model, considering the 4Ps of Marketing Product, Price, Place and Promotion	-	-	-	-
PC25. identify sources of funding, anticipate, and mitigate any financial/ legal hurdles for the potential business opportunity	-	-	-	-
<i>Customer Service</i>	1	2	-	-
PC26. identify different types of customers	-	-	-	-
PC27. identify and respond to customer requests and needs in a professional manner.	-	-	-	-
PC28. follow appropriate hygiene and grooming standards	-	-	-	-
<i>Getting ready for apprenticeship & Jobs</i>	2	3	-	-
PC29. create a professional Curriculum vitae (Résumé)	-	-	-	-
PC30. search for suitable jobs using reliable offline and online sources such as Employment exchange, recruitment agencies, newspapers etc. and job portals, respectively	-	-	-	-
PC31. apply to identified job openings using offline /online methods as per requirement	-	-	-	-
PC32. answer questions politely, with clarity and confidence, during recruitment and selection	-	-	-	-
PC33. identify apprenticeship opportunities and register for it as per guidelines and requirements	-	-	-	-
NOS Total	20	30	-	-

Qualification Pack

National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	DGT/VSQ/N0102
NOS Name	Employability Skills (60 Hours)
Sector	Cross Sectoral
Sub-Sector	Professional Skills
Occupation	Employability
NSQF Level	4
Credits	2
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	12/03/2026
Next Review Date	12/03/2029
NSQC Clearance Date	12/03/2026

Assessment Guidelines and Assessment Weightage

Assessment Guidelines

1. Criteria for assessment for each Qualification Pack will be created by the Sector Skill Council. Either each element/Performance Criteria (PC) will be assigned marks proportional to its importance in NOS. SSC will also lay down proportion of marks for Theory, viva and Skills Practical for each element/PC.
2. The assessment for the theory part will be based on knowledge bank of questions approved by the SSC.
3. Individual assessment agencies will create unique question papers for theory part for each candidate/batch at each examination/training center (as per assessment criteria below).
4. Individual assessment agencies will create unique evaluations for skill practical & viva for every student at each examination/ training center based on these criteria.
5. In case of successfully passing as per passing percentage of the job role, the trainee is certified for the Qualification Pack.
6. In case of unsuccessful completion, the trainee may seek reassessment on the Qualification Pack.

Minimum Aggregate Passing % at QP Level : 70

Qualification Pack

(Please note: Every Trainee should score a minimum aggregate passing percentage as specified above, to successfully clear the Qualification Pack assessment.)

Assessment Weightage

Compulsory NOS

National Occupational Standards	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks	Total Marks	Weightage
HSS/N5648.Comply to CSSD Process flow as per organizational policies and procedures	74	60	30	30	194	20
HSS/N5649.Manage availability, effectiveness and reprocessing of reusable medical devices	38	20	35	105	198	20
HSS/N5646.Receive, Inspect, Document, sterile and pack (label) CSSD items	105	55	45	30	235	20
HSS/N5650.Manage sterile stock of CSSD Items and work within sterile field boundaries	94	50	30	85	259	20
HSS/N5647.Perform Routine care of sterilizing apparatus and equipment	9	5	10	10	34	5
HSS/N9624.Maintain a safe and secure working environment	10	10	-	10	30	5
DGT/VSQ/N0102.Employability Skills (60 Hours)	20	30	-	-	50	10
Total	350	230	150	270	1000	100

Qualification Pack

Acronyms

NOS	National Occupational Standard(s)
NSQF	National Skills Qualifications Framework
QP	Qualifications Pack
TVET	Technical and Vocational Education and Training

Qualification Pack

Glossary

Sector	Sector is a conglomeration of different business operations having similar business and interests. It may also be defined as a distinct subset of the economy whose components share similar characteristics and interests.
Sub-sector	Sub-sector is derived from a further breakdown based on the characteristics and interests of its components.
Occupation	Occupation is a set of job roles, which perform similar/ related set of functions in an industry.
Job role	Job role defines a unique set of functions that together form a unique employment opportunity in an organisation.
Occupational Standards (OS)	OS specify the standards of performance an individual must achieve when carrying out a function in the workplace, together with the Knowledge and Understanding (KU) they need to meet that standard consistently. Occupational Standards are applicable both in the Indian and global contexts.
Performance Criteria (PC)	Performance Criteria (PC) are statements that together specify the standard of performance required when carrying out a task.
National Occupational Standards (NOS)	NOS are occupational standards which apply uniquely in the Indian context.
Qualifications Pack (QP)	QP comprises the set of OS, together with the educational, training and other criteria required to perform a job role. A QP is assigned a unique qualifications pack code.
Unit Code	Unit code is a unique identifier for an Occupational Standard, which is denoted by an 'N'
Unit Title	Unit title gives a clear overall statement about what the incumbent should be able to do.
Description	Description gives a short summary of the unit content. This would be helpful to anyone searching on a database to verify that this is the appropriate OS they are looking for.
Scope	Scope is a set of statements specifying the range of variables that an individual may have to deal with in carrying out the function which have a critical impact on quality of performance required.

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Knowledge and Understanding (KU)	Knowledge and Understanding (KU) are statements which together specify the technical, generic, professional and organisational specific knowledge that an individual needs in order to perform to the required standard.
Organisational Context	Organisational context includes the way the organisation is structured and how it operates, including the extent of operative knowledge managers have of their relevant areas of responsibility.
Technical Knowledge	Technical knowledge is the specific knowledge needed to accomplish specific designated responsibilities.
Core Skills/ Generic Skills (GS)	Core skills or Generic Skills (GS) are a group of skills that are the key to learning and working in today's world. These skills are typically needed in any work environment in today's world. These skills are typically needed in any work environment. In the context of the OS, these include communication related skills that are applicable to most job roles.
Electives	Electives are NOS/set of NOS that are identified by the sector as contributive to specialization in a job role. There may be multiple electives within a QP for each specialized job role. Trainees must select at least one elective for the successful completion of a QP with Electives.
Options	Options are NOS/set of NOS that are identified by the sector as additional skills. There may be multiple options within a QP. It is not mandatory to select any of the options to complete a QP with Options.